NISSANKA

Think Different.
Think AI.

Building confidence to work with AI responsibly.

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01 // FOUNDATION

Understanding AI.

How do you feel about AI at work?

01
Curious.

02
Excited.

03
Unsure.

04
Concerned.

You can feel more than one of these.

What comes to your mind when you think of AI?

TIME: THREE MINUTES

I. The Opportunity

Identify one concern about using AI at work

II. The Concern

Identify one concern about using AI at work.

In groups of three, discuss one opportunity and one concern.

04 // THE TEST

Can you tell which reply sounds most human?

Scenario: A hotel guest's airport transfer never arrived.

A.

I'm sorry your transfer didn't arrive. That's a poor start to your stay. Please send me your booking details and taxi receipt. I'll look into what happened and contact you today.

B.

Thank you for letting us know. We're sorry we let you down on arrival. Please share your booking reference and any taxi costs so we can investigate and agree the next steps with you.

C.

You shouldn't have been left waiting at the airport. I'm very sorry. Could you send your booking reference and taxi receipt? I'll check with our transport team and get back to you today.

VOL. LIX. No. 236.] [October, 1950

MIND

A QUARTERLY REVIEW

OF

PSYCHOLOGY AND PHILOSOPHY

I.—COMPUTING MACHINERY AND INTELLIGENCE

BY A. M. TURING

1. *The Imitation Game.*

I PROPOSE to consider the question, 'Can machines think?' This should begin with definitions of the meaning of the terms 'machine' and 'think'. The definitions might be framed so as to reflect so far as possible the normal use of the words, but this attitude is dangerous. If the meaning of the words 'machine' and 'think' are to be found by examining how they are commonly used it is difficult to escape the conclusion that the meaning and the answer to the question, 'Can machines think?' is to be sought in a statistical survey such as a Gallup poll. But this is absurd. Instead of attempting such a definition I shall replace the question by another, which is closely related to it and is expressed in relatively unambiguous words.

05 // THE ORIGIN

1950

"Can machines think?"

Alan Turing

Judge the behaviour, not the mechanism.

From a lab question to your inbox.

1956

Dartmouth

AI becomes a formal field of academic research.

1997

Deep Blue

Deep Blue beats the world chess champion.

2022

ChatGPT

ChatGPT brings conversational AI to a wider audience.

Which AI are we talking about?

Narrow AI

Designed for a specific task.

EXAMPLE: SPAM FILTERS

General-Purpose

Helps with many tasks. Can make mistakes.

TODAY'S ASSISTANTS

AGI

Human-level ability across a broad range of tasks.

NO AGREED BENCHMARK

ASI

Intelligence far beyond human capabilities.

HYPOTHETICAL

08 // THE MECHANISM

How AI learns.

I. Learning from examples

Uses examples with known answers to learn patterns.

EXAMPLE: RECOGNISING SPAM EMAILS

II. Finding patterns

Finds similarities in data without being given the answers.

EXAMPLE: GROUPING CUSTOMERS BY BUYING HABITS

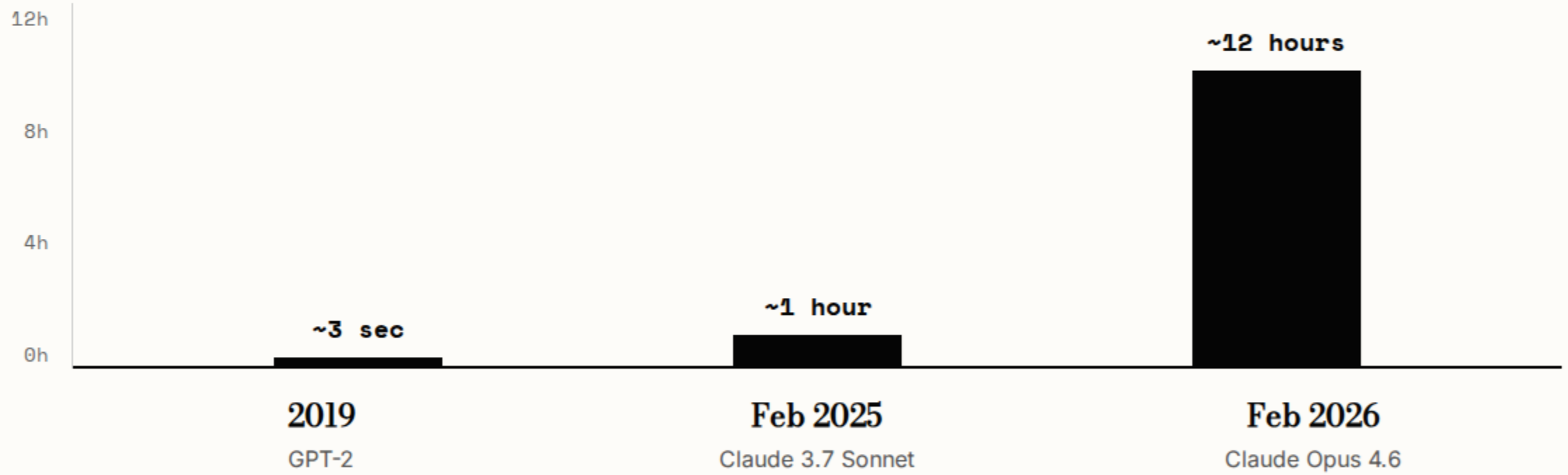
III. Learning through feedback

Tries different actions and learns from rewards.

EXAMPLE: LEARNING TO PLAY A GAME

Getting better, fast.

Task duration in skilled human time, at 50% AI success.



METR. Selected models and software tasks. This measures task difficulty, not the time an AI works independently.

SECTION 02 // CAPABILITY & APPLICATION

Seeing the possibilities.

People, work and leadership.

01 / STEERING

Leadership

Decide what to trust, check and keep human.

02 / CAPABILITY

People

Support learning while building judgement.

03 / DESIGN

Work

Look at the tasks inside each job.

> *"Turing asked whether machines can think. Our question is whether we can think well alongside them."*

Example of how AI can be used for work.

LABOUR INTELLIGENCE

AI for enterprise transformation

Right data, process, decisions and people, every shift.

Add video

CONVERSY VIDEO

Rehearsing a difficult conversation with AI.

Direct interrogation of organisational performance data for C-level decision-making.

Where AI falls short.

It can sound right and still be wrong.	Check important facts and claims.
It can do one task well and struggle with another.	Test it on the work you need it to do.
It can miss what matters in your situation.	Bring your knowledge of the people and business.

YOU REMAIN RESPONSIBLE FOR THE DECISIONS YOU MAKE.

Messy notes to clear actions.

DEMO 1 // FICTIONAL OPERATIONS NOTES

ops review tues. hotel: occupancy ok but breakfast complaints up, Nimal to check buffet restock times. retail: 3 stores low on rice again, supplier late?? Priya chasing. IT: new booking system go live pushed to end of month, nobody happy. need decision on temp staff for April season by fri, budget not agreed, someone to speak to finance. next meeting 2 weeks.

INPUT // RAW UNSTRUCTURED TEXT

ASK AI // THE PROMPT

"Turn these notes into three lists: decisions made, actions with an owner and a deadline, and open questions. If something is unclear, say so instead of guessing."

GUARDRAIL // SAY SO INSTEAD OF GUESSING

The sceptical CFO.

DEMO 2 // FICTIONAL BUSINESS PLAN

We plan to move invoice processing for our six business units into one shared team. Expected saving in year one: 12 percent of processing cost. Go live in four months.

INPUT // EXECUTIVE PROPOSAL

ASK AI // THE PROMPT

"Act as a sceptical CFO. Give me the three strongest objections to this plan and what evidence would answer each. Then run a premortem: it is a year from now and this failed. What went wrong?"

METHOD // STRESS-TESTING & PREMORTEM

One message, three audiences.

DEMO 3 // FICTIONAL STAFF ANNOUNCEMENT

From next month, kitchen and housekeeping shifts at three hotels will move from three shifts to two longer shifts.

INPUT // OPERATIONAL CHANGE

ASK AI // THE PROMPT

"Rewrite this announcement three ways: for the board in two sentences, focused on cost and risk; for the team in plain, warm language that answers 'what changes for me'; and for managers, with what they need to do this week. Then list the three questions staff will probably ask."

OUTPUT // BOARD, TEAM & MANAGER ALIGNMENT

What makes AI stick.

01 / EXAMPLE

Leadership

Use it visibly.

02 / CHAMPIONS

People

Build a network of early adopters.

03 / WORKFLOW

Work

Start with a task.

Keep a route to a person.

> *The tool is only one part of adoption.*

SECTION 03 // GOVERNANCE & GUARDRAILS

Using AI responsibly.

AI at work: what leaders may not see.

88%

of respondents had put work information into public AI tools.

66%

of workplace AI users had used tools they believed company policy did not allow.

38%

of respondents had shared AI-assisted work without mentioning AI's involvement.

Source: PagerDuty / Wakefield Research, 2026. Survey of 1,250 non-IT office professionals at companies with US$500m+ annual revenue, across Australia, Japan, the UK and US.

What happens to what you type.

It may help train AI models.

Depending on the tool, account and settings.

It may be stored or reviewed.

A private-looking chat does not guarantee confidentiality.

You may expose information entrusted to you.

Employee details, customer records and confidential business plans.

USE APPROVED TOOLS. SHARE ONLY INFORMATION PERMITTED FOR THAT USE.

APPROVED TOOL · WORK ACCOUNT · GREEN SHIELD

The enterprise version, and why it matters.

01 / MODEL BOUNDARY

Prompts and responses do not train foundation models.

02 / CONTRACTUAL SHIELD

Microsoft 365 protections cover the core chat.

03 / ACCESS CONTROL

Existing permissions govern access to work content.

04 / GOVERNANCE

Your organisation can retain and audit interactions.

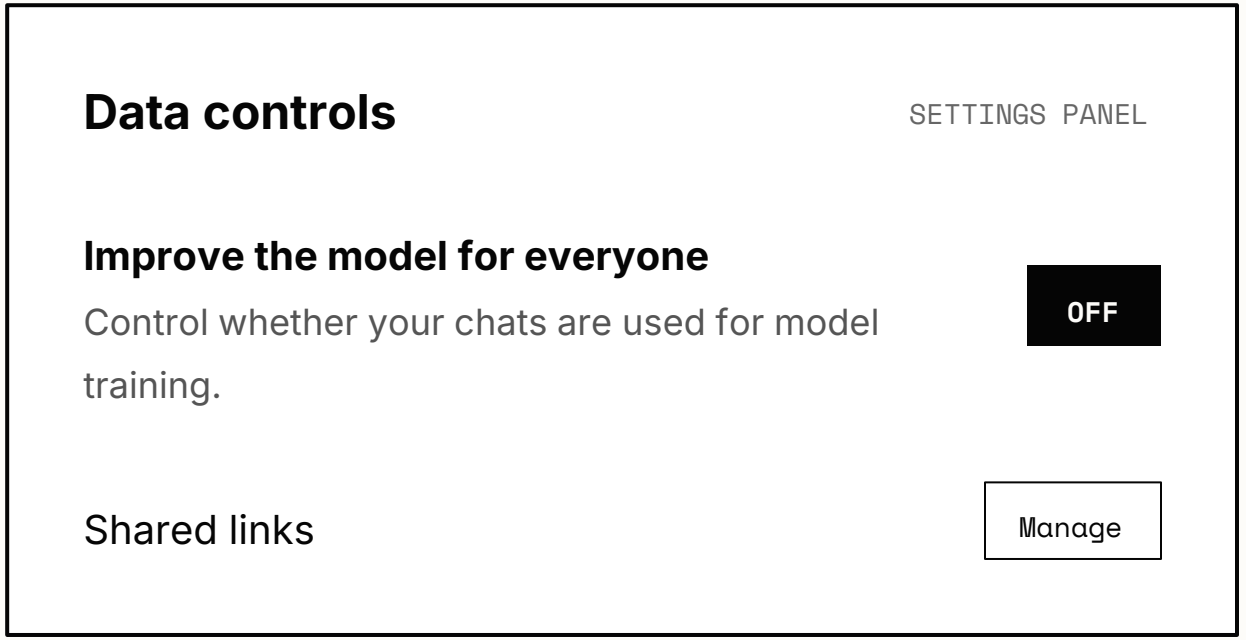
Microsoft Copilot example. Controls depend on licence and configuration. Web search and agents can have separate terms. Follow your organisation's policy.

ONLY WHERE YOUR ORGANISATION PERMITS THEIR USE

Personal tools: a second line of defence.

ChatGPT: Settings > Data controls

Turn off "Improve the model for everyone".



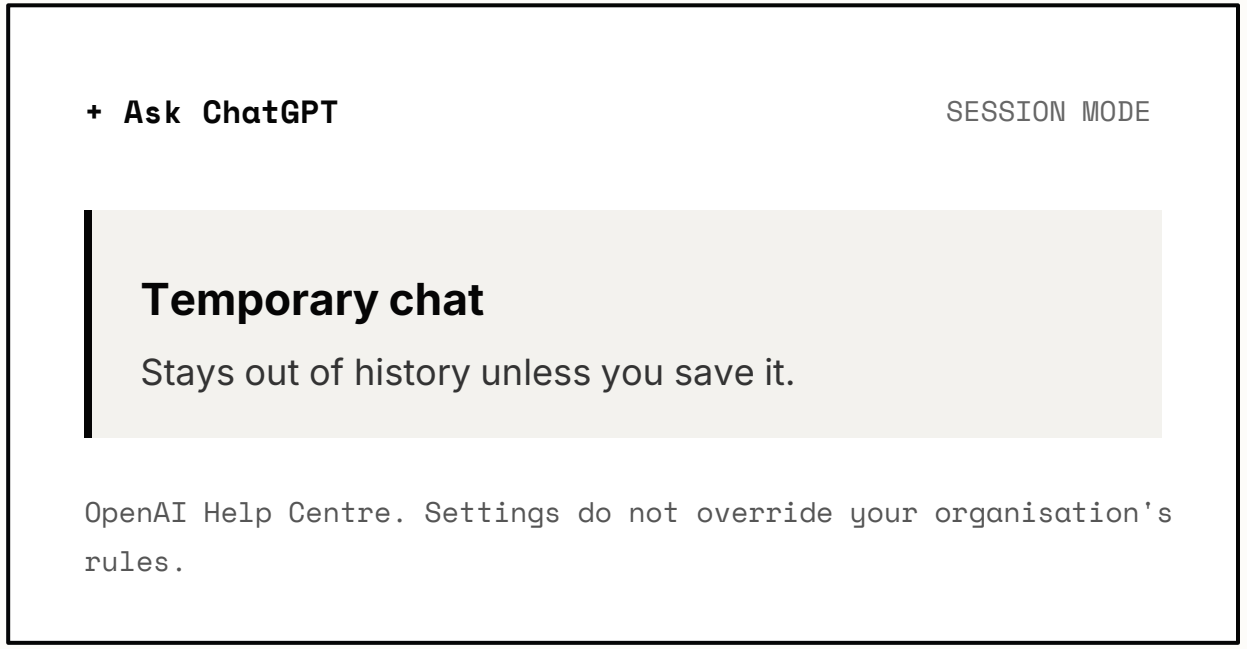
TRAINING OFF DOES NOT MEAN SAFE.

Personal tools: a second line of defence.

Temporary Chat: not used for training while temporary.

A copy may be kept for up to 30 days for safety.

If you save it as a regular chat, your account's training and retention settings apply.



TRAINING OFF DOES NOT MEAN SAFE.

Protect personal and confidential information.

REMOVE IDENTIFYING DETAILS FROM WORK EXAMPLES

BEFORE // EXPOSED IDENTIFIERS

"Write a warning letter for Kamal Fernando, Housekeeping Supervisor, salary Rs. 185,000, 14 Temple Road, Kandy, absent on 3, 7 and 12 March."

RISK: EXPOSING PERSONAL INFORMATION

AFTER // GENERIC SCENARIO

"Write a firm but fair warning letter for an employee who was absent without notice on three occasions in one month."

LOWER RISK: REMOVE IDENTIFYING DETAILS

Describe the task. Remove the identifying details.

Fictional example. Check the facts, fair process and company policy. Removing names alone may not prevent identification.

Check before you trust.

01	02	03	04	05
Facts.	Numbers.	Sources.	Fit.	What is missing?

Your name goes on it.

VERIFICATION MANDATE

Organisational boundaries.

A discussion guide. Your organisation's policy takes precedence.

GREEN	**Public information and general knowledge**	Use an approved tool.
AMBER	**Internal information that is not sensitive**	Use the approved enterprise tool for a permitted task.
RED	**Personal data, client secrets, unpublished figures**	Never in personal tools. Enterprise use needs specific authorisation.

NEVER PASTE PASSWORDS OR API KEYS INTO AI CHAT. ASK BEFORE YOU PASTE.

Think before you type.

Ask before you paste.

Three things to leave with.

01 // TOOLS

Use approved AI tools.

02 // PRIVACY

Protect personal and confidential information.

03 // JUDGEMENT

Check what matters.

SECTION 04 // STRATEGIC SYNTHESIS

Thinking with AI.

VIDEO EXAMPLE // HUMAN OVERSIGHT

Human in control.

A fictional example of AI assisting a person who remains in control.

The advantage comes from combining AI's capabilities with your experience and judgement.

Mindset transformation.

Growth Mindset

I can improve through learning and practice.

Challenges can help me learn.

Feedback helps me improve.

AI Mindset

I can think with AI.

My experience helps me judge its answers.

I can learn and share what works.

TRANSFORM YOUR BIGGEST FEAR

"Will AI replace me?"

"A.I. might not replace you, but a person who uses A.I. could."

PAOLO CONFINO AND AMBER BURTON — FORTUNE MAGAZINE (APRIL 2023)

"The cave you fear to enter holds the treasure you seek."

— JOSEPH CAMPBELL

Three Pillars of AI Thinking.

Augmentation

AI as a thinking partner.

Possibility

See beyond limitations.

Collective

Team amplification.

A suggested AIR learning plan.

A.

Absorb

Explore approved tools and learn their limits.

I.

Integrate

Apply AI to one suitable work task.

R.

Radiate

Share what worked and what you checked.

Your AIR action plan.

WEEKS 1–4 // A

Absorb

- Spend 15 minutes exploring approved tools.
- Test AI on a task you know well.
- Notice where its answer falls short.
- **Identify one useful opportunity.**

WEEKS 5–8 // I

Integrate

- Apply AI to one suitable task.
- Compare its suggestions with your own thinking.
- Check important facts and sources.
- **Record what improved and what needed correction.**

WEEKS 9–12 // R

Radiate

- Share a useful example with your team.
- Explain what you checked.
- Help a colleague get started safely.
- **Discuss the next opportunity with your manager.**

MY PREDICTION

The ability to think critically with AI will become an essential leadership skill.

- Curiosity to explore.
- Judgement to challenge.
- Responsibility to decide.

Two kinds of confidence.

Confidence in the AI

Less reported critical thinking.

Confidence in your own ability

More reported critical thinking.

Microsoft and Carnegie Mellon: 319 knowledge workers. 936 examples of AI use. Survey associations. This does not establish cause and effect.

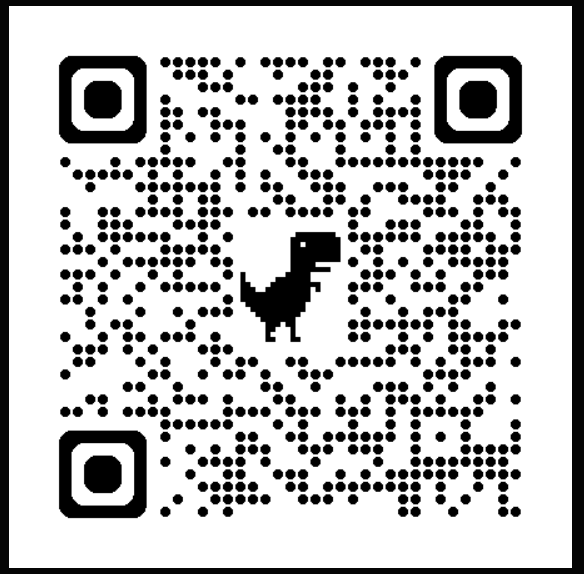
Think Different.
Think AI.
Think Possible.

What is one task you could approach differently this week?

"It is not the strongest of the species that survives, nor the most intelligent that survives. It is the one that is most adaptable to change."

— CHARLES DARWIN

Questions.



Take the thinking with you
Scan download the slides